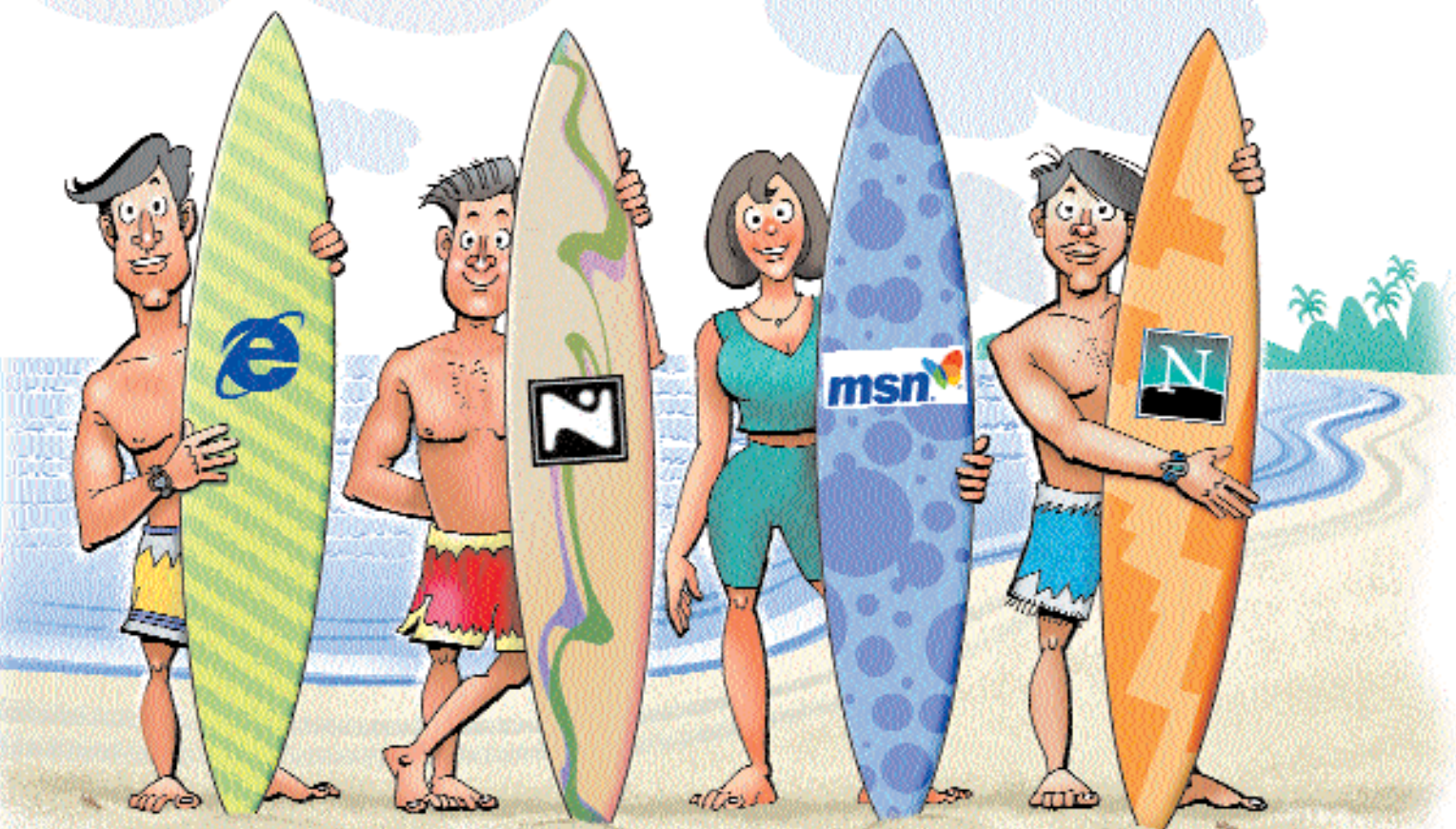


IN TEST: 10 BROWSERS

Illustration: Mahesh Benkar



Surf Wars

There are browsers and then there are browsers. Let's take a look at who stands head and shoulders above the others

MITUL MEHTA and VARUN SINGH

Wars have been waged and casualties suffered. Coffee vs Toffee, Mac vs PC, Windows vs Linux...these are some of the memorable ones. Here and now you shall be witness to yet another battle royale—the battle between your favourite browsers.

Netscape used to be the king of browsers, but ever since Internet Explorer 3.0 was launched, it has been losing popularity and market share. This can be attributed to the aggressive push Microsoft has given its Internet Explorer by integrating it fully into Windows and pre-bundling it as a requirement for many other programs to work. This has helped speed up the development of many other browsers, resulting in an onslaught of

alternatives that promise to be as functional as, or even better than, IE and Netscape.

With new competitors pouring into the arena, the choice becomes more difficult. If you use the Windows OS, you already have a browser, Internet Explorer, a slow-moving beast with a past chequered by bugs and security loopholes. But if you seek change, all you have to do is resort to some quick surfing and avail of numerous options with better performance, more features and lighter browsers with low memory usage.

Just a look at the list of browsers available can send you into a tizzy. Download.com has more than a hundred browsers listed. There are a number of theme-based browsers such as the Christmas Browser (with a Christmas theme for